

Drone Search Scenarios

- Hasty - especially if there is a lot of ground to cover
- Hazardous - steep or hazardous terrain - send in the drones.
- Below Canopy - small ducted drones.

Hasty

- Above Canopy
- Prefer bigger drones with spotlights, IR and zoom cameras.
- Bigger drones should deploy day, night and in mild weather.
- Open prop drones > 40 minutes battery life.
- Bigger open prop drones prefer deployment from vehicle.
- Smaller drones don't have IR or zoom cameras, but can help if flown just above treetops in broad daylight and good weather.

Hazardous

- Smaller drones can be carried by ground pounders to explore steep or dangerous terrain and extend reach of ground team.
- River canyons that are difficult to reach by ground team and dangerous due to fast water are ideal candidates for larger drones with zoom cameras.

Below Canopy

- Especially steep or treacherous canyons
- Smaller ducted drones requiring more experienced pilots (type 2 or 1)
- Smaller ducted drones have less battery life (less than 20 minutes).
- Dense foliage limits search distance due to signal interference.
- Smaller drones backpack portable, but search duration limited.

Prefer vehicle deploy:

- Enables starlink connectivity.
- Supports battery recharge for extended search duration.
- Supports rapid redeploy for additional search coverage.